

4 — Getting Around

(Plain-English version of [docs/05-navigation.md](#). Read that file for the full detail.)

How people move around the app. These rules apply on phone, tablet, and desktop.

The main rules

1. **5 tabs, forever:** Today · Bible · Library · Tribe · Me. New features join a tab; the nav never grows.
2. **The Bible is in the centre.** On the phone's bottom bar, Bible sits in the middle slot — on purpose. It's the foundation.
3. **Reachable with one thumb.** Main navigation and main buttons live in the lower part of the screen.
4. **Never trap the user.** Every screen has an obvious way back.
5. **Navigation stays calm.** No number badges on the tabs — except the notifications bell. No red dots competing for attention.

On the phone (the main device)

The bottom bar is always there:



- Always show icon **and** label (labels help younger and second-language readers).
- Active tab: filled icon, green colour, bolder label. Inactive: outline icon.
- The bar **hides when reading** (Bible and long articles) and comes back when you scroll up — reading is the one time to remove distractions. Everywhere else it stays put.
- Tapping the tab you're already on scrolls back to the top.
- Each tab remembers where you were.

Top bar

Changes per screen: a title or logo, a search icon (Library, Bible, Tribe), a notifications bell (Today, Tribe). The Bible reader has its own special top bar (book/chapter button, translation button, search).

No hamburger menu

There is **no** hidden side menu for teens. The 5 tabs cover everything. (The leader Console is different — it can have a side menu on desktop.)

On tablet and desktop

- **Teen app on a bigger screen:** the bottom bar becomes a **side rail** with the same 5 items. The desktop version is just a wider version of the phone app — not a different design. Reading text still stays a comfortable narrow width.
- **The Console** is built for desktop, with a side menu and breadcrumbs (like `Console → Events → Camp → Sign-ups`).

Search

Search is an icon in the top bar, not its own tab. It searches whatever screen you're on: search from the Bible searches the Bible; from Library it searches content; from Tribe it searches events.

Notifications

- The bell (top bar) opens the notifications inbox. This is the same inbox found under Me.
- The bell shows an unread count, capped at "9+".
- Reminders are smart: once today's devotional is done, the reminders for that day stop.

Going back

- On Android, the back gesture is sacred — it always goes back one step, and never gets hijacked into "are you sure?" pop-ups (except during a form or a payment).
- Pushed screens show a back arrow at the top-left.
- **The most important back path:** when you tap a verse inside a devotional and it opens the Bible, a "← Back to devotional" chip stays visible. Reading → Bible → back is the single most important loop in the whole app.

Remember where people are

The app remembers: your Bible reading position, which tab you were on, playing audio (the mini-player follows you across tabs), and half-filled forms.